



PLASTICS FOR
CHANGE

Annual Report 2024

Foreword

At Plastics For Change, we believe that waste is not just an environmental challenge—it is an opportunity to create lasting social and economic impact. Every year, millions of tonnes of plastic waste threaten our oceans, communities, and ecosystems. But within this crisis lies a powerful solution: empowering the informal waste sector and building a circular economy that works for both people and the planet.

Since our inception, we have worked to bridge the gap between global brands and waste collectors, ensuring that ethical, traceable recycled plastic becomes a standard in supply chains. More importantly, we have championed the rights and dignity of waste collectors—those who stand at the frontline of the plastic waste crisis—by providing fair wages, financial inclusion, and better working conditions.

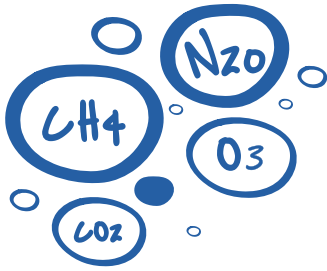
This past year, our journey has been one of both growth and resilience. We have expanded our impact, strengthened our partnerships, and driven systemic change in the plastic recycling ecosystem. Yet, the road ahead demands even greater commitment. We must scale solutions, mobilize global action, and continue advocating for policies that make waste management a fair, sustainable, and inclusive industry.

This report reflects our progress, our challenges, and our vision for the future. As we move forward, we invite you—our partners, supporters, and change-makers—to join us in shaping a world where waste is valued, plastic is circular, and people are empowered.

Together, we can turn waste into a force for good.

-Andrew Almack , Founder and CEO

Waste and the Triple Planetary Crisis

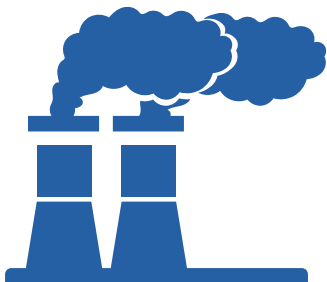
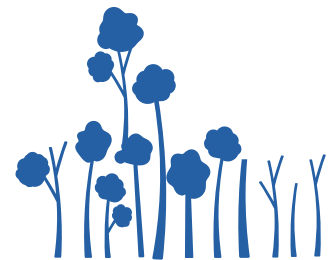


Climate Change

Transporting, processing and disposing of waste generates CO₂ and other greenhouse gases and airborne pollutants that contribute to climate change.

Biodiversity Loss

Indiscriminate waste disposal practices can introduce hazardous chemicals into soil, water bodies and the air, causing long-term, potentially irreversible damage to local flora and fauna, negatively impacting biodiversity, harming entire ecosystems, and entering the human food chain.



Pollution

Between 400,000 and 1 million people die every year as a result of diseases related to mismanaged waste that includes diarrhoea, malaria, heart disease and cancer (Williams et al. 2019).

Executive Summary



Environmental Impact

Diverted

24,619

metric tons of plastic waste from the ocean and landfill

Social & Economic Empowerment

Directly benefited

6,670

waste collectors, scrap shop owners, workers and their family through increased income and formalization



**This Year,
We
Worked across**



Plastic Collection

Sourcing

Achieved highest sourcing in all Aggregation center



15%

increase in collection
from 2023

Stakeholder

The stakeholders are scrap shop workers, waste collectors and scrap shop owners

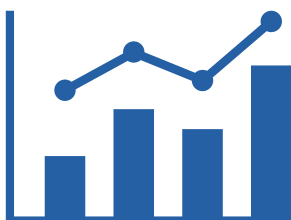


1998

stakeholders received **a fair price**

Volume growth

Volume growth procurement compared to 2023

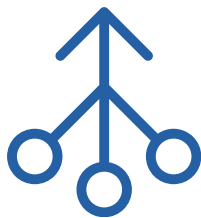


233%

volume growth in Polyolefins

Franchise Partnership Launch

The plastic waste recycling chain is an extremely competitive supply chain: there are large tensions between the informal and the formal waste sectors. The informal sector, in a decentralised approach, competes very well in this area, despite extremely poor conditions. We recognized their potential for growth to be formalised and capacitated through the right combination of investment, technical assistance and market facilitation to help them overcome the constraints that have limited their size and revenues. This year, we introduced a franchise model to formalize small scrap shops under fair trade standards, providing training, branding, and digital tools.



Formalization of Aggregators

has increase their operational efficiency, improve segregation and increase collection capability.



Successful franchise partnership with 3 scrap shop

Partnership in three location in Mysore, Vizag & Kumta.



1127 Mt of plastic diverted

from the landfill and the environment



By **adopting fair trade practices**—ensuring fair wages, a safe working environment, and zero bonded or child labor—our business became a model for ethical entrepreneurship. With new infrastructure provided by PFC, we have embraced environmental sustainability by using solar power for production, including the segregation belt, and fully electric vehicles for sourcing.

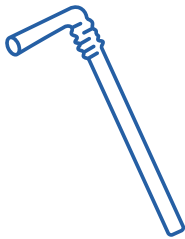
This transformation has not only improved operations but also changed lives. I was able to provide stable jobs, particularly for five women in my village. Many of them, who previously had no income opportunities, now have dignified work and financial independence.

Through continuous innovation, mentorship, and access to global markets, what once seemed like an impossible journey has now become a thriving, **impactful business**. Today, I am not just running a business—I am driving change, proving that sustainable growth and community well-being can go hand in hand

-Indu Aiyapa, Franchisee partner, Mysore

Launch of Plastics for Change Market Place

Launched in 2024, our plastic waste marketplace has rapidly expanded its reach, now operating across 24 states. With a strong state presence, we ensure total volume security, guaranteeing a steady supply of recyclable materials. Our commitment to quality and consistency enables us to serve our clients efficiently while fostering a more sustainable plastic waste management system. Through innovation and collaboration, we continue to drive circular economy solutions and reduce environmental impact at scale.



Reducing marine plastic debris

by facilitating the collection, processing, and recycling of plastic waste



18,475 Mt of plastic collected

to promote circular economy solutions



Expanding Impact

Operating across 24 States in India

Building Resilient Communities with Recycled Plastic

Over 85% of waste collectors live in slums, often without basic amenities. Additionally, 70% lack access to toilets, 60% do not have clean drinking water, and more than 50% live without electricity.

To address this, PFC has pioneered the use of multi-layered plastic (MLP) waste to construct durable, low-cost row houses. By transforming plastic waste into sustainable building materials, PFC is providing waste-collector communities with safer, more resilient homes, improving their quality of life while promoting circular economy solutions.



Safe living conditions

includes a robust housing ecosystem, good sanitation, hygiene awareness and accessibility to water.



40 tons of plastic diverted

to promote circular economy solutions



Constructed 27 houses using recycled construction panel

Each recycled panel is crafted from multi-layered plastic (MLP), with every house diverting 1.2 tons of plastic waste from oceans



"Before, the rains used to come into my house. It was made of tarpaulin sheets and wood, and during the monsoon, it would break and fall apart around us. It was hard to keep my children safe.

Now, thanks to the PFC team, we have a **proper home** with a kitchen and a hall. We finally have enough space to eat, sleep, and rest in comfort. Most importantly, we are now **safe**.

I am overjoyed and deeply grateful for this new beginning. This home has given my family hope for a better future."

— Vasanthi, Waste Collector, Pallavaram Community

Reducing Carbon: Sustainable Innovations in Waste Collection

PFC procured and deployed 2 electric vehicles and 10 electric tricycle to optimise plastic waste collection specifically targeting the first-mile connectivity problem in plastic collection and recycling.



Increased Income

substantial rise in monthly incomes for beneficiaries, with some doubling their earnings, up to ₹15,000 per month



Reduced Distance

Enhanced mobility post-intervention, with average distances covered increasing from 13 KM to 27



Tripled Plastic Collection

with averages rising from 10kg to 30kg daily. For instance, beneficiaries like Arunagiri and Sathya saw substantial jumps from 50 to 150 kg/day, indicating enhanced efficiency and capacity



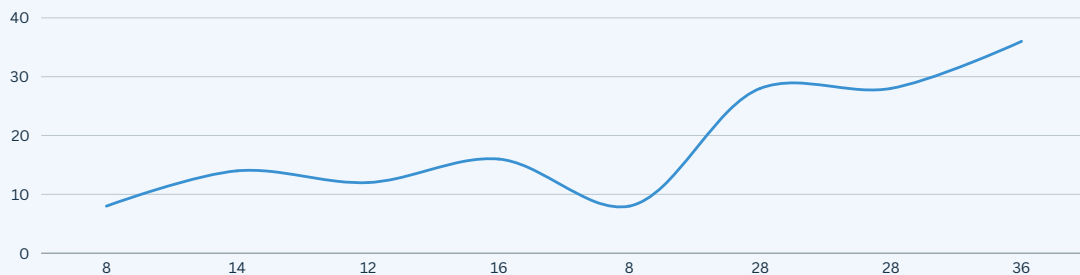
"I am a waste collector working at Deepa Scrap Shop. Earlier, I could only collect waste within a 2-3 kilometer radius, limiting my earnings. But after receiving the e-tricycle, my work has completely transformed. Now, I can travel up to **15-20** kilometers a day and collect up to **40** kilograms of waste daily.

This tricycle has been extremely helpful, not only in increasing my income but also in improving my family's quality of life. With this support, we are moving forward with hope and stability. Thank you for providing this opportunity, it has truly made a difference."

Raj, Waste collector, Chennai

Empowering Women, Transforming Recycling

This initiative aims to create economic opportunities for women waste collectors by establishing a Fair Trade Scrap Shop. The goal is to equip them with the necessary training, support, and resources to become successful entrepreneurs while promoting sustainable waste management practices. This program enhances their skills, economic stability, and social status, fostering ethical practices within the recycling supply chain.



5 women open a fair trade scrap shop

Established 5 women-owned Plastic Collection Centers (PCCs), providing leadership opportunities and financial independence.



Increased Income Opportunities

Women gain financial independence and improved earning potential.



Leadership Development

Women entrepreneurs take leadership roles, influencing sustainable practices in their communities.



“The support I received has been instrumental, and I am truly grateful for it. It not only helped me establish my own waste collection business but also changed my family’s future. With this opportunity, my husband secured a stable job as a security guard, and my children now receive educational benefits.

Through hard work and determination, I was able to afford a second-hand car, which has made my work more efficient. Today, I earn between **₹20,000 to ₹30,000** every month—something I never imagined before. Everything has been progressing well, and now I dream of building my own house, a place that will bring happiness to my children and husband.

This journey has given me **confidence**, independence, and the hope for a better future. I am proud of what I have achieved and grateful to be part of this transformation.”

-Hanumamave, Scrap Shop Entrepreneur, Mangalore

Special Advocacy Projects: Restoring Our Shores with Beach Cleanups

To address the rising levels of pollution at surrounding beaches, PFC organised 8 beach clean-up programme across coastal cities in India to remove trash from beaches and waterways. The clean up campaign jointly promoted the message of keeping our shorelines clean and protecting our sea together.

Beach cleanups raised public awareness to the threat of debris more effectively than in less participatory public education programs. The cleanups made volunteers more mindful of how they dispose of their own disposables. They also added to the growing body of knowledge about where and how plastics travel across the seas and where they end up in the greatest abundance.



2000 Volunteers

took part in clean-up beaches



6000 kg of plastic

collected from the marine environment



Instilling behavioural change

to reduce waste at source, protect ocean and keep the beaches clean



Responsible Sourcing In India

Responsible sourcing in India is gaining significant traction, with leading brands increasingly seeking sustainable and ethical supply chain partners. As the demand for traceable, recycled plastic rises, PFC has positioned itself as a trusted ally in helping L'oreal and Oriflame to move towards circular economy. By integrating informal waste collectors into formal supply chains, PFC ensures that plastics are ethically sourced, environmentally responsible, and fully traceable.

PFC's responsible sourcing model not only diverts ocean-bound plastic but also creates lasting social impact. By offering fair pricing, promoting financial inclusion, and supporting access to education and healthcare, PFC empowers waste- communities, especially women, to become key players in the recycling economy.

Our partnerships with global brands demonstrate how responsible sourcing can drive both business value and community transformation.

We are setting a precedent for inclusive, sustainable development across India's waste management sector.

L'ORÉAL

ORIFLAME
— S W E D E N —

Launch of Fabrics of Change



This year, we launched recycled fabrics that are revolutionizing the textile industry driven by our three core principles: transparency, traceability, and efficiency, from waste to fiber.

We are bridging the gap between waste and fashion by maintaining complete transparency throughout the recycled textile supply chain. By partnering with fiber producers, spinners, weavers, and garment manufacturers, we are co-creating a diverse range of recycled fibers, yarns, and fabrics.

To date, we've successfully diverted **138.132** metric tonnes (MT) of recycled fibers. PFC is turning waste into valuable, sustainable fashion materials.



recycled polyester
fiber



recycled
polyester yarn



recycled polyester
fabric

Financial Performance

